young Druze who are more comfortable speaking in Hebrew than Arabic.) And yet even a brief tour around their villages demonstrates that they do not receive commensurate benefits. A 2013 study found that Druze schools receive, on average, 5,000 shekels less per pupil than their state-run Jewish counterparts.[12]

The same could be said of the tiny Circassian minority, which is concentrated in two relatively poor towns in the north. Or the Bedouin, who often serve with distinction in the army—they man an elite unit of trackers, guarding the borders—and then return home to poverty and dispossession, and the ever-present threat of eviction by the state. But they also exist within the Jewish majority. The Ethiopians emigrated to Israel decades ago, yet many of them still feel somewhat less than full citizens. Amongst Ashkenazim and Mizrahim the schism is less stark, but it still rears its head. (A Western-educated friend with the surname Mizrahi once told me about her struggle to find a job—"We thought you were from Holon," one relieved interviewer told her, referring to a predominantly Mizrahi suburb of Tel Aviv.)

The *haredim* present a particular set of challenges. On a practical level, Israeli governments depend on their support. Even when a cabinet manages to pass reforms, as it did during Netanyahu's third, they can be quickly undone, as would happen during his fourth. And they present a symbolic dilemma: how can the Jewish state fight with a group of people who seem the most fervently, outwardly "Jewish"?

This same dilemma underlies the broader tension between Israel's Jewish and democratic identity. In their efforts to portray Israel as a liberal country, politicians and propagandists often focus on a set of cultural issues, the most common of which is gay rights. In 2014, the *hasbara* group StandWithUs ran a splashy ad campaign in the *New York Times*. "Hamas, ISIS and Iran kill gays like me," read one full-page advertisement, illustrated with a black-and-white photo of a gay American named Rennick Remley. "In Israel, I am free."

It is, to an extent, a fair argument. Gays and lesbians have more rights under Israeli law than in some Western countries, let alone elsewhere in the Middle East. The state recognizes same-sex marriages performed abroad; gay couples can adopt children; discrimination based on sexual orientation has been illegal since the 1990s. When the Israeli military started allowing gays to serve openly, the US hadn't even issued the "don't ask, don't tell"